Global Markets Daily: Japanese Repatriation Flows—What Matters Most for the Yen

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- Japan Post Bank's CEO recently said that the bank may double its JGB holdings over time, sparking renewed questions on the potential impact and scope for broader repatriation flows. Many have also been arguing that the 10-year JGB yield at multi-decade highs and the Yen at historically cheap levels strengthens the case to return capital home. We think the reality is more nuanced.
- Japanese investors, excluding the MoF, hold nearly $6tn of foreign assets, with the majority mostly unhedged. As a result, any coordinated reallocation towards domestic securities should be a source of notable JPY appreciation. Japan Post Bank, however, would unlikely be the driver as it tends to invest largely on a hedged basis. Nor do we think it should be indicative of future decisions by unhedged investors. An increase in Post Bank's JGB holdings could matter more for rates markets if it is indeed the result of rotating away from foreign securities rather than simply adjusting its JPY portfolio.
- GPIF is the key Japanese investor that can have the most impact on FX. It is one of the largest holders of foreign assets, it tends to invest mostly unhedged, and private pensions often follow its allocation decisions. GPIF conducts a strategy review every five years and the last one occurred in 2025, leaving any big changes unlikely before 2030. But it can still shift its holdings within target allocation bands. With current holdings close to the midpoint of the range in each asset, there is room for some adjustment.
- That said, we remain skeptical of significant JPY-positive repatriation flows without a more favorable rate differential. In fact, we think the case for any coordinated, unhedged reallocation towards JGBs looks even less compelling now than earlier this year, when Fed cuts were less in question.

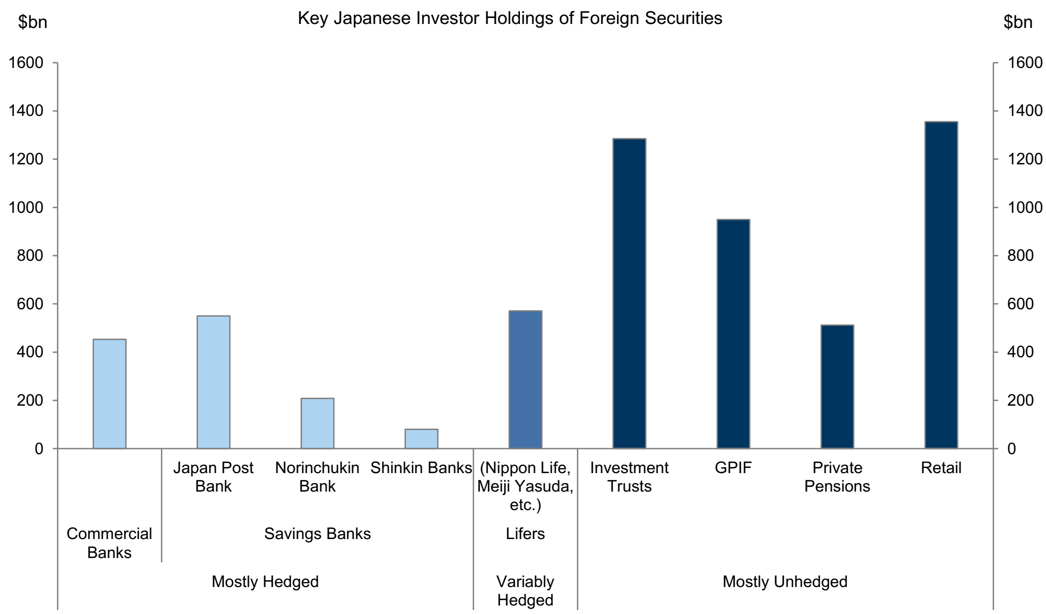
Japanese Repatriation Flows—What Matters Most for the Yen

Japan Post Bank's CEO recently said that the bank may double its JGB holdings over time—back to a level last seen over a decade ago—sparking renewed questions on the potential impact and scope for broader repatriation flows.[1] Many have also been arguing that the 10-year JGB yield at multi-decade highs and the Yen at historically cheap levels strengthens the case to return capital home. We think the reality is more

[1] Japan Post Bank is a savings bank. It was formerly government-owned through Japan Post Holdings, but it is now in the process of privatization.

nuanced. Our *Investor's Guide to Japanese Portfolio Flows* outlines the data to watch and the investors to follow, and how to track and anticipate foreign asset demand. We show that Japanese investors, excluding the MoF, hold nearly $6tn of foreign assets, with the majority mostly unhedged (Exhibit 1). As a result, any coordinated reallocation towards domestic securities should be a source of notable JPY appreciation. Post Bank, however, would unlikely be the driver as it tends to invest largely on a hedged basis. An increase in Post Bank's JGB holdings could matter more for rates markets if it is indeed the result of rotating away from foreign securities rather than simply adjusting its JPY portfolio.[2]

Exhibit 1: Japanese investors (excluding the MoF) hold nearly $6tn of foreign assets, with the majority mostly unhedged



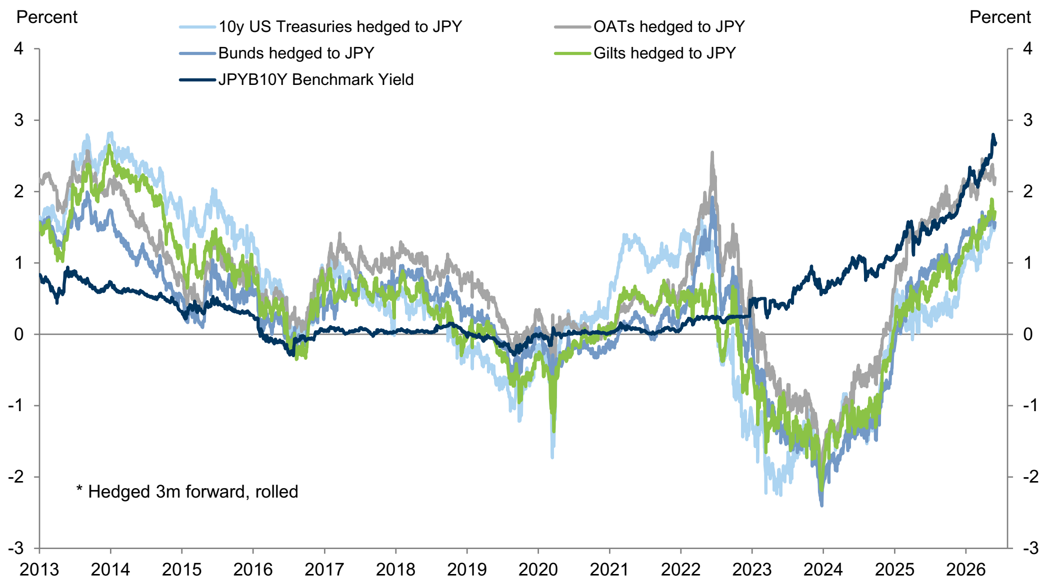
Data from Post Bank and GPIF financial reports, the BoJ's April FSR, and Flow of Funds data (Outward Investment in Securities + Investment Trust Beneficiary Certificates) as of Q4 2025.

Source: BoJ, Haver Analytics, GPIF, Japan Post Bank, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Post Bank is the biggest single holder of foreign bonds in Japan after the MoF. As of March 2026, according to Post Bank's latest financial statement, it had roughly $550bn of foreign holdings, mainly in bonds. As a mostly hedged investor, Post Bank should theoretically care most about the gap between JGB yields and hedged foreign yields. While that gap remains positive across key regions, global yields have been rising alongside JGB yields in recent months, leaving the relative attractiveness of JGBs more stable despite multi-decade highs in the 10-year JGB yield (Exhibit 2). The yield differential is also not the only consideration, and some investors may still be hesitant to buy if they see risks of bonds cheapening further, especially due to rising risk premium rather than rate expectations.

[2] Post Bank's midterm plan suggests that it may be the latter, which would make the shift less impactful for bonds as well.

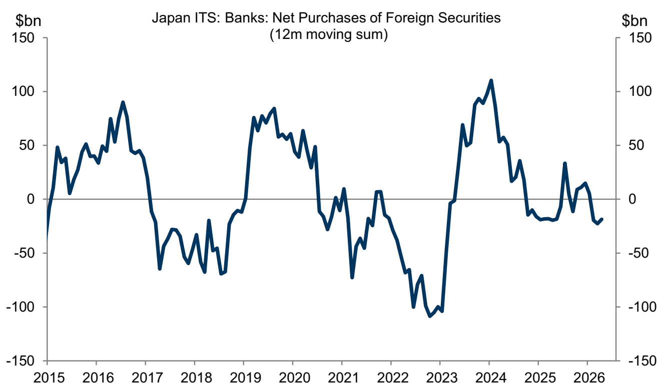
Exhibit 2: Due to the rise in global yields, the relative attractiveness of JGBs has been more stable despite multi-decade highs in the 10-year JGB yield



Source: Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

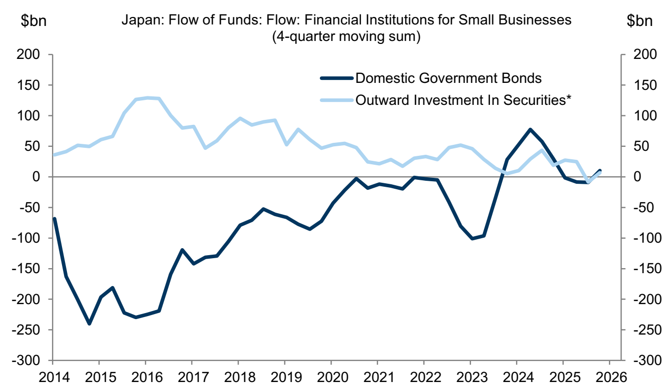
If Post Bank were to shift back towards domestic assets, this would be most meaningful for bond investors. As we have previously noted, the first signs of any pivot should appear in the "Banks" flows in the International Transactions in Securities (ITS) data (as reduced foreign asset purchases or outright sales). The flow could then be more comfortably attributed to Post Bank if Financial Institutions for Small Businesses in the subsequent Flow of Funds (FOF) report shows similar selling of foreign securities and buying of JGBs. So far, there have been limited signs of any meaningful repatriation. While the ITS data show that Banks flows have turned negative since the start of the year (Exhibit 3), the more-lagged FOF data have yet to confirm any shift (Exhibit 4). The latest data as of Q4 2025 suggest that while Post Bank bought more JGBs, it also continued buying foreign assets.

Exhibit 3: While the ITS data show that Banks flows have turned negative since the start of the year...



Source: MoF, Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: ...the more-lagged FOF data have yet to confirm any shift



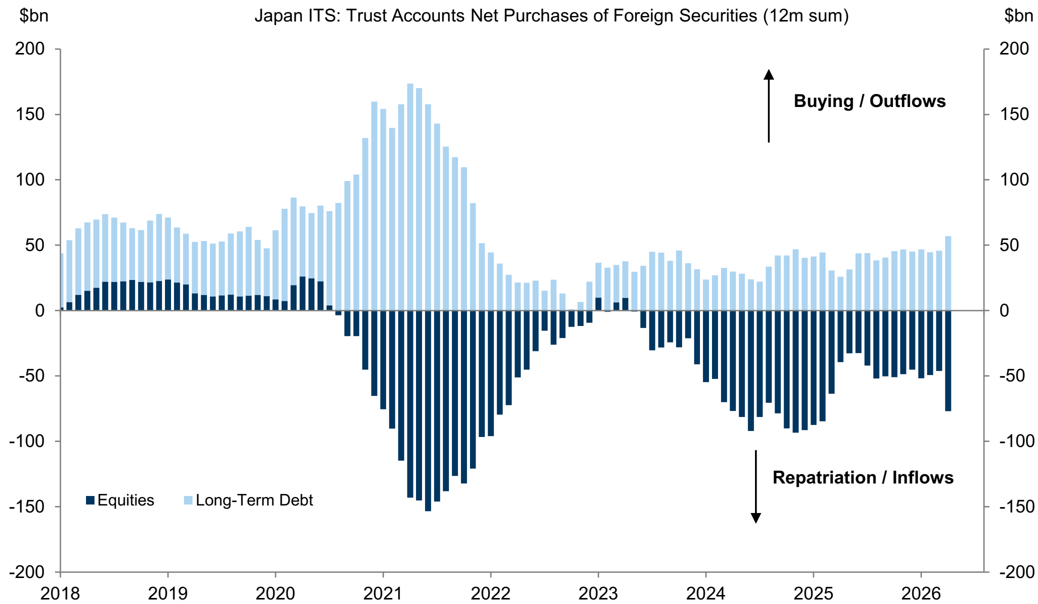
*Includes Investment trust beneficiary certificates to capture foreign assets purchased through a domestic asset manager. See Global Markets Analyst: An Investor's Guide to Japanese Investor Flows for more.

Source: BoJ, Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

The more meaningful shift for FX would be a shift in strategy by GPIF, Japan's public pension fund. It is one of the largest holders of foreign assets (nearly $1tn in total), it tends to invest mostly unhedged, and private pensions often follow its allocation decisions. GPIF conducts a strategy review every five years and the last one occurred in 2025, leaving any big changes unlikely before 2030. That said, it can still shift its holdings within target allocation bands. The latest reported holdings stand close to the midpoint of the range in each asset class, suggesting room for some adjustment. Theoretically, if GPIF were to cut its foreign bond holdings to the bottom of its allowable range (20%) and shift those proceeds into JGBs (bringing its allocation to 30%), it could total up to $87bn. Such an adjustment would unlikely occur all at once, but it reflects some scope for notable flows if desired—or directed by the administration. So far, the timeliest data suggest that GPIF and the private pensions have continued buying foreign debt while selling foreign equities (Exhibit 5).[3]

[3] We show in Global Markets Daily: The Japanese Portfolio Flow Data in Practice that GPIF and private pension flows are recorded under "trust accounts" in the monthly ITS data. We also noted in the piece that in periods of significant equity gains, GPIF needs to sell stocks to keep the allocation close to 25%.

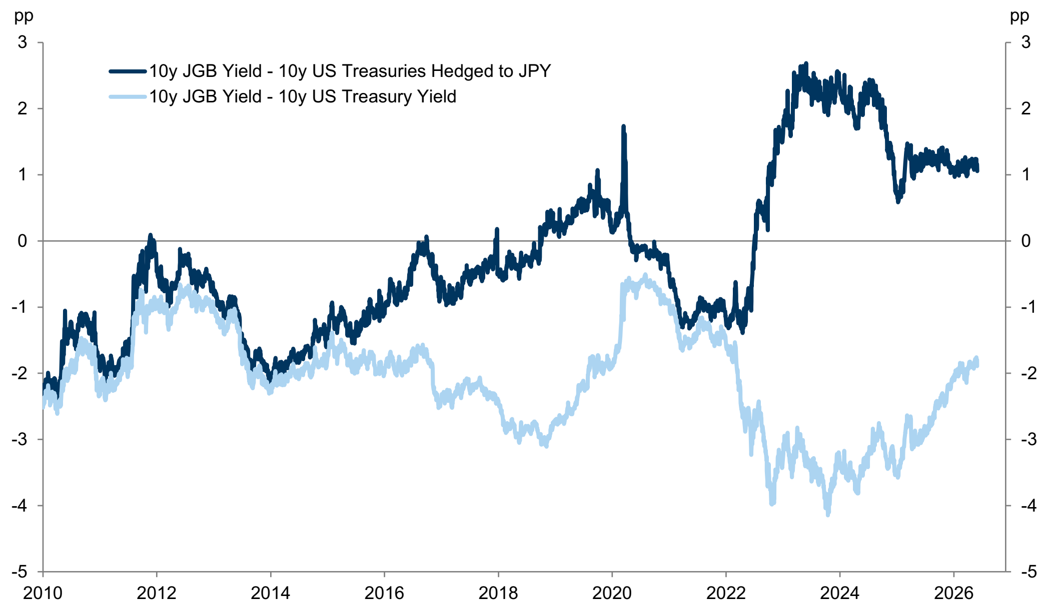
Exhibit 5: The timeliest data suggest that GPIF and the private pensions have continued buying foreign debt while selling foreign equities



Source: MoF, Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Importantly though, any shift in Post Bank's allocation should not necessarily be indicative of future GPIF decisions. While the investment calculus for a hedged investor looks more favorable for JGBs, the case for GPIF (an unhedged investor) to reallocate back towards domestic bonds over the near-term looks less compelling. GPIF aims for positive returns—it has a target of nominal wage growth + 1.9%—and therefore should care most about rate differentials when investing unhedged. For example, while JGB yields have risen more than UST yields over the past year, the differential remains negative (Exhibit 6).

Exhibit 6: While JGB yields have risen more than UST yields over the past year, the differential remains negative



Source: Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Without a more favorable rate differential, we remain skeptical of significant JPY-positive repatriation flows. There could still be more notable rotation back towards JGBs among hedged investors, especially if the Fed pivots towards rapid rate hikes, like in 2022. But we think the case for any coordinated, unhedged reallocation towards JGBs looks even less compelling now than earlier this year, when Fed cuts were less in question.

TRADE IDEAS

Best Trade Ideas Across Assets

For pricing, charts, and a list of previous recommendations, please visit our Trade Ideas page.

1. Stay short SGD/MYR, opened January 24, 2026, at 3.13, with a target at 2.90 and a stop at 3.30, currently trading at 3.12.
2. Stay long TRY, NGN and KZT against the USD, as an equally weighted basket, opened February 18, 2026, at 0%, with a total return target of 7.5%, and a revised stop of 0%, currently trading at 2.1%.
3. Stay long USD/SEK, opened March 20, 2026, at 9.3443, with a target at 9.65 and a stop at 9.00, currently trading at 9.4147.
4. Stay long 3y France, Spain, Italy vs OIS (equally weighted), opened April 10, 2026, at 0.33, with a target at 0.23 and a revised stop at 0.32, currently trading at 0.30.
5. Stay long MSCI Korea and Taiwan (equal weight) vs. short MSCI India, Philippines, Thailand (equal weight), opened April 16, 2026, at 100, with a revised target of 155

and a revised stop of 125, currently trading at 142.

6. Stay short EUR/HUF, opened 17 April 2026, at 361, with a target of 350 and a stop of 372, currently trading at 356.
7. Stay long 3y SOFR swap spread, opened 17 April 2026, at -22.6bp, with a target at -18bp inclusive of carry; and a revised stop at -23bp, currently trading at -20.3bp.
8. 2s5s CAD steepener, opened 24 April 2026, at 20bp, with a target at 35bp and a revised stop at 20bp, current trading at 22bp.
9. Stay short USD/EGP, opened 24 April 2026, at 0%, with a total return target at 6% and a stop at -3%, currently trading at 2.8%.
10. Stay long 5y5y EUR OIS – HICP, opened 01 May 2026, at 1.09%, with a target at 0.88% and a stop at 1.22%, currently trading at 1.03%.
11. Stay long 5y Receivers on 3m 2s5s10s Receiver Fly (bp running), opened 09 May 2026, at 1bp, with a target at 10bp and a stop at -5bp, currently trading at -1bp.
12. 1y forward 2s10s GBP OIS steepeners, opened 29 May 2026, at 0.38, with a target at 0.55 and a stop at 0.25, currently trading at 0.34.
13. Receive 2Y ZAR OIS, opened 03 June 2026, at 7.47%, with a target at 7.00% and a stop at 7.90%.

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We, Karen Reichgott Fishman and Lexi Kanter, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views, which have not been influenced by considerations of the firm's business or client relationships.

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